

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Saxenda (Liraglutide 6mg/ml) solution for injection in pre-filled pen for the treatment of Weight management in adults

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Weight management in adults

NICE Guidance on Obesity and Weight Management

Weight management interventions are recommended for adults with a body mass index (BMI) $\geq 30 \text{ kg/m}^2$, or $\geq 27 \text{ kg/m}^2$ with weight-related comorbidities. Lifestyle modifications including reduced calorie intake and increased physical activity are the cornerstone of weight management. Pharmacological intervention with anti-obesity drugs, such as GLP-1 receptor agonists (e.g., liraglutide), may be considered as an adjunct to lifestyle changes in eligible patients.

Liraglutide (Saxenda) Overview

- GLP-1 (Glucagon-Like Peptide-1) receptor agonist indicated for chronic weight management
- Mechanism of action: Acts on GLP-1 receptors in the central nervous system to promote satiety, delay gastric emptying, and improve glycaemic control
- Administered as subcutaneous injection once daily

Indication and Patient Selection

- **Eligibility criteria:** Adults aged 18 years and over with initial BMI $\geq 30 \text{ kg/m}^2$ or $\geq 27 \text{ kg/m}^2$ with at least one weight-related comorbidity such as dysglycaemia, hypertension, dyslipidaemia, or obstructive sleep apnoea
- Patients must be motivated to achieve weight loss and committed to lifestyle modifications (reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity)

Efficacy and Expected Outcomes

- Clinical trials demonstrate approximately 5-10% body weight reduction from baseline in responders
- Response is assessed at 12 weeks on the maintenance dose (3.0 mg daily); discontinue if <5% body weight loss achieved
- Improvements in weight-related comorbidities (glycaemic control, blood pressure, lipid profile) may be observed

Important Safety Considerations

- Absolute contraindication: Personal or family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma (MTC) or Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia syndrome type 2 (MEN 2)
- Caution in patients with history of pancreatitis, significant renal or hepatic impairment, inflammatory bowel disease, or gastroparesis
- Risk of hypoglycaemia increases when used with insulin or sulfonylureas; dose adjustment of these agents may be required
- Common adverse effects include gastrointestinal symptoms (nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, constipation), which typically diminish over time

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Saxenda (Liraglutide 6mg/ml) solution for injection in pre-filled pen

for the treatment of

Weight management in adults

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines • All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Adjunct to reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity for weight management in adults with initial BMI ≥ 30 kg/m ² or ≥ 27 kg/m ² with at least one weight-related comorbidity (e.g., dysglycaemia, hypertension, dyslipidaemia, obstructive sleep apnoea)
Inclusion criteria	Age 18 years and over BMI ≥ 30 kg/m² or ≥ 27 kg/m² with at least one weight-related comorbidity Willing and motivated to undertake lifestyle modifications (reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity) Informed consent obtained No contraindications as listed in exclusion criteria

Exclusion criteria	Known hypersensitivity to liraglutide or any component of the product Personal or family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma (MTC) Personal or family history of Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia syndrome type 2 (MEN 2) Pregnancy or breastfeeding Severe heart failure (NYHA class IV) Severe hepatic impairment (Child-Pugh score C or equivalent) Severe renal impairment (eGFR <30 mL/min/1.73m²) Concurrent use of other GLP-1 receptor agonists Recent (within 3 months) acute pancreatitis or chronic pancreatitis with ongoing risk factors Acute illness or recent surgery
Cautions	History of pancreatitis (risk of pancreatitis recurrence) Mild to moderate renal impairment (eGFR 30-60 mL/min/1.73m²) Mild to moderate hepatic impairment Inflammatory bowel disease (may be exacerbated) Gastroparesis or other gastrointestinal disorders Thyroid disease (monitor thyroid function if symptoms develop) Concomitant medications that affect blood glucose control (insulin, sulfonylureas) - hypoglycaemia risk History of depression or suicidal ideation (monitor mental health) Acute illness or significant dehydration Concurrent use of medications affecting gastric motility
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Liraglutide 6mg/ml solution for injection in pre-filled pen
Legal category	POM (Prescription Only Medicine)
Storage	Before first use: Store at 2-8°C in a refrigerator. After first use: Store below 30°C for up to 30 days. Do not freeze. Protect from light. Do not use if the solution is discoloured or contains particles.
Route/method of administration	Subcutaneous injection into the abdomen, thigh, or upper arm. Inject at any time of day, preferably the same time each day. Not to be

	administered intravenously (IV) or intramuscularly (IM).
Dose and frequency	Titration schedule (over 5 weeks to maintenance dose): • Week 1: 0.6 mg once daily (subcutaneous injection) • Week 2: 1.2 mg once daily • Week 3: 1.8 mg once daily • Week 4: 2.4 mg once daily • Week 5 onwards: 3.0 mg once daily (maintenance dose) If dose escalation is not tolerated, consider delaying by approximately one week before continuing titration. Maintenance dose: 3.0 mg once daily by subcutaneous injection
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	Up to 5 pre-filled pens per supply (approximately 1 month at maintenance dose; each pre-filled pen contains 18 mg liraglutide)
Maximum or minimum treatment period	Review at 12 weeks on the maintenance dose (3.0 mg daily). Discontinue if <5% body weight loss has been achieved. If treatment is continued, review at least every 6 months thereafter. Longer treatment duration may be considered in patients achieving sustained weight loss of ≥5% body weight.
Adverse effects	Very common (≥1/10): Nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, constipation Common (≥1/100 to <1/10): Hypoglycaemia (primarily in patients with type 2 diabetes mellitus receiving concurrent glucose-lowering therapy), headache, dizziness, abdominal pain, dyspepsia, flatulence, injection site reactions (erythema, induration), fatigue, increased serum lipase Uncommon (≥1/1,000 to <1/100): Dehydration, tachycardia, cholelithiasis, cholecystitis, acute cholecystitis Serious (reportable): Pancreatitis (persistent severe abdominal pain with or without vomiting), anaphylaxis, angioedema, thyroid nodules or neoplasms, depression, suicidal ideation

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: • that valid informed consent was given • name of individual, address, date of birth and GP • name of healthcare practitioner • name and brand of medication • date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied • advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment • details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken

	supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: - Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years - Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)
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Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with Saxenda. Ensure the patient understands the injection technique, storage requirements, and when to seek medical advice.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Inject using the correct subcutaneous technique. Rotate injection sites to avoid lipohypertrophy. Dispose of used needles safely in a sharps container. Take the injection at the same time each day for consistency. It can be taken at any time of day but choosing a fixed time may aid compliance. Continue with a reduced-calorie diet and increase physical activity as advised. Weight management is most effective when medications are combined with lifestyle modifications. Expect initial gastrointestinal side effects (nausea, vomiting) which typically improve over the first few weeks. Take the medication with food if nausea is problematic. Stay well-hydrated. Report persistent or severe abdominal pain immediately, as this may indicate pancreatitis. If you experience signs of hypoglycaemia (shakiness, sweating, confusion, rapid heartbeat) - particularly if taking insulin or sulfonylureas - inform your GP or healthcare provider, as dose adjustment of these medications may be needed. Inform your healthcare provider if you develop symptoms of thyroiditis (neck pain, swelling, difficulty swallowing) or depression/mood changes. Do not freeze the medication. Before first use, store at 2-8°C. After opening, store below 30°C for up to 30 days. Attend all review appointments. Weight loss will be monitored at 12 weeks, and treatment will be discontinued if <5% body weight loss is achieved. Do not share your medication with others. Saxenda is prescribed specifically for you based on your medical history and BMI.

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance: Obesity: identification and management
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			
Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date	Expiry date		
1/11/25	31/7/27		

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		2/11/25
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		2/11/25

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	1st November 2025